



AFTER

Despite the approaching enemy, morale among the soldiers in the Northern encampments remained strong. But Lee's Confederates were also bolstered.

RENEWED NORTHERN MORALE

Within the Union army itself, most soldiers were regaining their morale as **reports of the enemy** in their "home" territory reached their encampments. Fighting and losing in Virginia because of inept commanders was one thing, but **engaging the Confederates on Northern soil** was another. Under a new commander—General George Meade—the Army of the Potomac was ready for the chance to defeat the Confederates. As one officer reported: "The **men are more determined** than I have ever before seen them."

INVINCIBLE SOUTHERNERS

As the Confederates moved northward, **optimism among the men in the ranks soared**. Southerners were eager to crush the Yankees once and for all. During the advance, Lee's army kidnapped around 1,000 free Black Americans and took them back South into slavery. **An aura of invincibility** ran throughout the Rebel camps, a confidence bred of repeated battlefield success.